

Yuxi Wu, PhD

Distinguished Postdoctoral Research Fellow
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Summary

I am a **human-computer interaction** and **design** researcher specializing in **human-centered privacy and security**. I examine how the entanglement of algorithmic technologies and digital services into society has resulted in concrete harms to people's privacy. I create uplifting, social designs to help people navigate these challenging contexts.

Education

Georgia Institute of Technology *Ph.D., Computer Science. 2024.*

Dissertation: "Designing Collective Action Systems for User Privacy."

Advisors: Sauvik Das and W. Keith Edwards.

Committee: Joseph Calandrino, Christopher Le Dantec, Richmond Wong, Ellen Zegura.

University of Chicago *M.S., Computational Analysis and Public Policy. 2018.*

University College London *B.A., Economics and Business. 2015.*

Academic Appointment

Northeastern University *Distinguished Postdoctoral Research Fellow. 2024 to present.*

Faculty Mentor: Alexandra To.

Selected Awards

JP Morgan Chase *AI Research PhD Fellowship. 2023 to 2024.*

Georgia Institute of Technology *President's Fellowship. 2019 to 2023.*

CSCW *Best Paper Honorable Mention. 2021.*

Publications

Refereed Conference Papers and Journal Articles

- [12] **Yuxi Wu** and Alexandra To. 2026. Hike Your Own Hike: Noticing Through Iterative Physical Disorientation. In *Proceedings of the 2026 Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS)*.
- [11] Youngwook Do, Tingyu Cheng, **Yuxi Wu**, HyunJoo Oh, Daniel J Wilson, Gregory D Abowd, and Sauvik Das. 2025. On-demand RFID: Improving Privacy, Security, and User Trust in RFID Activation through Physically-Intuitive Design. In *Proceedings of the Symposium on Usable Security and Privacy (USEC)*.
- [10] **Yuxi Wu**, William Agnew, W Keith Edwards, and Sauvik Das. 2025. Design(ing) Fictions for Collective Civic Reporting of Privacy Harms. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW)*, 9, 2, 1–26.
- [9] **Yuxi Wu**, Jacob Logas, Devansh Ponda, Julia Haines, Jiaming Li, Jeffrey Nichols, W Keith Edwards, and Sauvik Das. 2025. Modeling End-User Affective Discomfort With Mobile App Permissions Across Physical Contexts. In *Proceedings of the Symposium on Usable Security and Privacy (USEC)*.
- [8] **Yuxi Wu**, Alexandra To, Emilee Rader, W Keith Edwards, and Sauvik Das. 2025. Transformational Provocations for Usable Privacy and Security: Designing Beyond Compliance and Expert Norms. In *Proceedings of the 2025 New Security Paradigms Workshop (NSPW)*.
- [7] **Yuxi Wu**, Ruoxi Zhang, Shiyue Liu, Mufei He, Aidan Hong, Jeremy J. Northup, Call Kainaroi, Fei Fang, and Hong Shen. 2025. Navigating Security and Privacy Threats in Homeless Service Provision. In *Proceedings of the 34th USENIX Security Symposium (USENIX Sec)*.
- [6] **Yuxi Wu**, Sydney Bice, W Keith Edwards, and Sauvik Das. 2023. The Slow Violence of Surveillance Capitalism: How Online Behavioral Advertising Harms People. In *Proceedings of the 2023 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT)*, 1826–1837.
- [5] **Yuxi Wu**, W Keith Edwards, and Sauvik Das. 2022. “A Reasonable Thing to Ask For”: Towards a Unified Voice in Privacy Collective Action. In *Proceedings of the 2022 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*, 1–17.
- [4] **Yuxi Wu**, W Keith Edwards, and Sauvik Das. 2022. SoK: Social Cybersecurity. In *2022 IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy (Oakland)*. IEEE, 1863–1879.
- [3] Youngwook Do, Jung Wook Park, **Yuxi Wu**, Avinandan Basu, Dingtian Zhang, Gregory D Abowd, and Sauvik Das. 2021. Smart Webcam Cover: Exploring the Design of an Intelligent Webcam Cover to Improve Usability and Trust. *Proceedings of the ACM on Interactive, Mobile, Wearable and Ubiquitous Technologies (IMWUT)*, 5, 4, 1–21.
- [2] Sindhu Kiranmai Ernala, Stephanie S Yang, **Yuxi Wu**, Rachel Chen, Kristen Wells, and Sauvik Das. 2021. Exploring the Utility Versus Intrusiveness of Dynamic Audience Selection on Facebook. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW)*, 5, CSCW2, 1–30.
- [1] **Yuxi Wu**, Panya Gupta, Miranda Wei, Yasemin Acar, Sascha Fahl, and Blase Ur. 2018. Your Secrets Are Safe: How browsers’ explanations impact misconceptions about private browsing mode. In *Proceedings of the 2018 World Wide Web Conference (WWW)*, 217–226.

Organized Workshops

- [1] **Yuxi Wu**, Beatriz Palacios Abad, Vishal Sharma, Hanlin Li, and Alexandra To. 2025. Alternative Technology Consumption Under Capitalism. In *Companion Publication of the 2025 Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing*, 1–3.

Invited Articles (Lightly Peer-Reviewed)

- [2] Sauvik Das and **Yuxi Wu**. 2022. From Our Fellows: How Online Behavioral Advertising Harms People. *Center for Democracy and Technology*.
- [1] Sauvik Das, W Keith Edwards, DeBrae Kennedy-Mayo, Peter Swire, and **Yuxi Wu**. 2021. Privacy for the People? Exploring Collective Action as a Mechanism to Shift Power to Consumers in End-User Privacy. *IEEE Security & Privacy*, 19, 05, 66–70.

Posters and Workshop Papers (Non-Archival, Lightly Peer-Reviewed)

- [3] **Yuxi Wu**. 2025. Journaling Privacy Harms. In *9th Workshop on Technology and Consumer Protection (ConPro)*.
- [2] **Yuxi Wu**, William Agnew, W Keith Edwards, and Sauvik Das. 2024. Design(ing) Fictions for Collective Civic Reporting of Privacy Harms. *6th Annual Symposium on Applications of Contextual Integrity (PrivaCI)*.
- [1] **Yuxi Wu**, W. Keith Edwards, and Sauvik Das. 2023. SoK: Social Cybersecurity. *Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS)*.

Works In Preparation and Preprints

- [2] Youngwook Do, **Yuxi Wu**, Gregory Abowd, and Sauvik Das. 2026. Physically-intuitive Privacy and Security: A Design Paradigm for Building User Trust in Smart Sensing Environments. eprint: [arXiv.2604.00312](https://arxiv.org/abs/2604.00312).
- [1] **Yuxi Wu**, Sanonda Gupta, John S. Seberger, and Nora McDonald. A work about ontological gaps in HCI privacy literature and “posthuman” privacy. *Under review*.

Invited Talks and Guest Lectures

Indiana University Host: Luddy School of Informatics, Computing, and Engineering. 03/26.
“Finding Meaning in Privacy Amidst Digital Entanglement.”

University of Chicago CAPP Seminar Host: Anne Rogers, UChicago MSCAPP Program. 11/25.
“Reckoning with Privacy Harms from Technology Entanglements.”

Northeastern University Host: Alexandra To. 04/25.
“Taxonomizing, Measuring, and Responding to Privacy Harms.”

American Association for the Advancement of Science (AAAS) Annual Meeting. 02/25.
“Designing Collective Action Systems for User Privacy.”

University of Maryland–Baltimore County School of Public Policy. 04/24.
“Taxonomizing, Measuring, and Responding to Privacy Harms.”

University of Maryland–College Park *Host: Dana Priest. 01/24.*
“Ad Technology Infrastructures.”

Carnegie Mellon University *Host: Sauvik Das. 03/23.*
“Designing Collective Action Systems for User Privacy.”

Georgia Institute of Technology *Host: Alyssa Sheehan. 07/21.*
“Privacy for the People.”

Academic Service

Service to the Discipline

Associate Chair

DIS 2026 Critical Computing & Design Theory Subcommittee
CHI 2026 Privacy and Security Subcommittee
CHI 2025 User Experience and Usability Subcommittee

Program Committee

USENIX Security Posters 2025
CCS 2025
CSCW Posters 2024
USEC 2024, 2025, 2026

Reviewer

CHI 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024*
CHI LBW 2022
CSCW 2022, 2024
DIS 2021, 2024
IEEE S&P Magazine
**Special Recognitions for Outstanding Reviews*

Student Volunteer

CHI 2022
IEEE S&P 2022

Institutional Service

PhD Recruiting and Outreach, Georgia Institute of Technology

Panelist, Current PhD Students in Interactive Computing 2020, 2023, 2024
Panelist and Member, Graduate Women in College of Computing 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024
Student Reviewer, Georgia Tech School of Interactive Computing PhD Admissions 2024

Teaching Experience

Northeastern University, Khoury College of Computer Sciences

Guest Lecturer

Human-Computer Interaction, Spring 2026

Human-Computer Interaction, Spring 2025

Georgia Institute of Technology, College of Computing

Co-Instructor

Usable Privacy and Security, Spring 2023

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Human-Computer Interaction, Fall 2023

Computing, Society, and Professionalism, Fall 2022

User Interface Design, Summer 2021

Guest Lecturer

Computing, Society and Professionalism, Spring 2022

User Interface Design, Summer 2021

University of Chicago, Harris School of Public Policy

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Data Skills for Public Policy (R), Winter 2018.

Introduction to Programming for Public Policy (Python), Fall 2017.

Advising and Mentorship

PhD Students

Sanonda Gupta, Drexel University

Kelly Wang, Northeastern University

Master's Students

Skye Toral, Northeastern University

Regina Wang, Northeastern University

Undergraduate Students

Ruoxi (Pauline) Zhang, Carnegie Mellon University

Shiyue (Zoe) Liu, Carnegie Mellon University

Sydney Bice, Georgia Institute of Technology

Stephanie Yang, Georgia Institute of Technology

Nancy Wang, Georgia Institute of Technology

Grants and Funding

Awarded

Northeastern University *Distinguished Postdoctoral Fellowship* (\$50,000). 2024 to 2026.

JP Morgan Chase *AI Research PhD Fellowship* (Tuition and Stipend). 2023 to 2024.

ACM FACCT *Travel Grant* (\$1400). 2023.

IEEE S&P *Student Travel Grant* (\$1300). 2022.

Georgia Institute of Technology Gvu Center *Travel Grant* (\$300). 2022.

Georgia Institute of Technology *President's Fellowship* (\$22,000). 2019 to 2023.

Submitted

Deriving Dialectical Value from Targeted Advertisements Co-PI with Mat Kelly (Drexel University).

Additional Experience

Democratic National Committee *Mobilization Analytics Manager*. 2018 to 2019.

Led Mobilization data team during 2018 midterm elections. Oversaw data warehouse migration from Vertica to BigQuery. Designed experiments for grassroots fundraising and voter outreach. Modeled donor engagement and prospects. Created, maintained, and overhauled reporting pipelines for the DNC and vendors.

Dept. of Computer Science, University of Chicago *Research Assistant*. 2017 to 2018.

Worked with Prof. Blase Ur to research user misconceptions about private browsing.

Urban Center for Computation and Data *Research Assistant*. Summer 2017.

Performed time series analyses and density-based clustering of Chicago crime data.

Skills and Methods

Programming and Technical Python (Pandas, PyTorch, Scikit-learn, statsmodels), SQL, Google BigQuery, R (tidyverse), Stata, HTML/CSS, $\text{\LaTeX}$

Research and Design Survey and questionnaire instrument design, qualitative data analysis, quantitative data analysis, interviewing, discussion moderation, design fiction, storyboarding